

Captain Penny and the Wishing Treasure Chest

Pirate story • 3-4 years old



Captain Penny woke up early on her pirate ship, the Happy Dolphin. The sun was waking up too, painting the sky with soft pink and gold. Penny stretched her arms and looked out at the calm blue ocean. “Good morning, sea!” she called. The waves splished and splashed. Penny laughed. “Are you happy today?” she asked the water. The ocean seemed to giggle back.

Today was a big day for Captain Penny. She had a special map. The map was old and crinkly. It showed a tiny island with a big red X. That means treasure, Penny thought. But it was not just any treasure. On the map was a picture of a happy, round chest. “Find me and open me, but be gentle,” the writing said. Penny smiled. She liked to do things gently.

Her best friend, Squeaky the parrot, flew to her shoulder. “Ready, Penny?” squeaked Squeaky. Penny nodded. “Ready, Squeaky!” she said. Squeaky flapped his bright green wings. He loved treasure hunts.

The crew of the Happy Dolphin woke up too. There was Tilly with the little hat, Max with the big boots, and Bubble the sleepy cat, who loved napping in sunny spots.

“All aboard for adventure!” Penny called. The ship’s sails stretched high and white. The wind was good. Fluffy clouds danced in the sky above.

As they sailed, Penny spotted dolphins jumping. She waved. The dolphins did flips. Squeaky cheered, “Hooray for dolphins!” The crew laughed.

Soon, dark clouds began to roll in. The sky turned gray. “Uh-oh,” whispered Tilly. “A storm!” Penny stood tall. “No worries,” she said. “Hold on, everyone! We know what to do!”

The waves grew bigger—whoosh, swoosh! The wind howled—woo-whish! Rain came down, pat-pat-pat. “I’m not scared!” Penny shouted. “We’re pirates! We can handle a little rain.” Max helped tie the ropes. Tilly closed the big, squeaky hatch. Bubble the cat snuggled in a cozy box.

Penny grabbed the wheel. She steered the ship very carefully. The Happy Dolphin bobbed up and down, like a rubber ducky in a bath. “Left a little, right a little!” Penny sang. Squeaky flapped and squawked, “Go, Penny, go!” Penny smiled at her brave friends.

Soon, the storm rolled away. The sun peeked out. The sea sparkled again. “Hooray!” cheered the crew. Penny smiled. “We did it! Good job, everyone!”

Miles and miles of blue passed by. Penny looked at her map again. “Almost there!” she told Squeaky. Squeaky danced a silly pirate jig.

At last, Penny saw the island from the map. It was small and round. Palm trees waved hello. Seagulls swooped and called, “Treasure! Treasure!” Penny and the crew went ashore in a little boat. Bubble the cat bounced along with them, his tail high in the air.

On the sand, Penny spread out the old map. “The X is by the biggest palm tree,” she said. Everyone looked. There it was! A tall tree with bright green leaves and two sleepy coconuts.

Tilly brought a tiny shovel. “Let’s dig,” said Penny. Dig, dig, dig! The sand was soft and warm. Soon, Tilly’s shovel clinked on something hard. “We found it!” Penny cheered.

They brushed off the sand. There was a shiny, round chest. It looked happy, just like the picture on the map. It had a funny smiling face and sparkly seashell buttons.

Penny remembered the map’s words. “Open me, but be gentle.” She touched the chest softly. “Hello, treasure!” Penny whispered. She looked for a tricky lock or a secret button. Nothing. She thought hard. Penny liked to think.

Suddenly, Squeaky pecked the chest’s big, friendly nose. Click! The chest giggled—a soft, gentle giggle. The lid popped open, slow and careful.

Inside, there were not gold coins or jewels. There were little letters. Each one was rolled up and tied with a ribbon. Penny took one and unrolled it. It said, "For the bravest and kindest pirate, thank you! Inside this chest are wishes from pirates everywhere. Take one and make a wish for your crew."

Penny smiled big. "I wish for more adventures, smiles, and sunny days," she said.

Tilly wished for funny hats. Max wished for giant boots. Bubble the cat wished for more naps in the sun. Squeaky wished for a mountain of crackers. Everyone laughed and laughed.

The treasure chest closed with a happy wiggle. The crew waved goodbye to the island. Back to the Happy Dolphin they went, carrying the chest filled with warm wishes and giggles.

The ship sailed home. The sun glowed orange and pink. Penny hugged Squeaky. "That was the best treasure," she said. "The best treasure is a happy crew and lots of wishes."

Squeaky agreed. "Best pirate day ever," he squawked.

Night came. The stars twinkled. The Happy Dolphin rocked gently on the sea. Penny snuggled in her bed. Bubble the cat curled at her feet. Squeaky softly sang a pirate lullaby.

Penny closed her eyes and smiled. She dreamed of more adventures, blue waves, and happy wishes, safe in her cozy pirate ship with all her friends.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the captain of the ship?

- Captain Penny
- Captain Max
- Captain Bubble
- Captain Squeaky

2) What did the map show?

- A little island with an X
- A big city
- A desert
- A playground

3) What kind of animal is Squeaky?

- A parrot
- A cat
- A dolphin
- A dog

4) What was inside the shiny chest?

- Little letters with wishes
- Gold coins
- A big toy
- A map

Correct answers:

1) Captain Penny 2) A little island with an X 3) A parrot 4) Little letters with wishes

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Crinkly: A sound or feel like thin paper that is bent and makes small noises.

Gentle: Soft and careful, not rough or hard.

Crew: All the people who work together on the ship.

Giggle: A small, happy laugh, short and quiet.

Hatch: A small door on a ship, low on the floor.

Bobbed: Moved up and down like a little ball on water.

Peeked: Looked quickly or shyly, just a little bit.

Ashore: On the land after coming from a boat or the sea.

Clinked: Made a small, bright metal or hard sound.

Coconuts: Round, hard fruits that grow on palm trees.

Sparkled: Shined with many little bright lights.

Sparkly: Covered with tiny shiny bits that catch light.

Treasure: Special things that people find and keep, like gifts.